

WALLY MOSTAFA

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Dear Planning Pod team,

What caught my attention about the Product Associate role was how plainly Planning Pod describes the work. Talk with customers, turn what you learn into clear requirements, write documentation people can use, stay close to engineering, demo what was built, and follow through. Those are responsibilities I genuinely enjoy.

I also understand that this is a junior position. My background is more experienced than the 0-2 years in the posting, and I am comfortable with that. The level does not change how interested I am in the work. I want to spend my day close to customers and the people building the product, doing the hands-on work that helps a team make better decisions.

I have always seen UX as the foundation of good product development. Customer interviews are how a team learns what people actually need and where a workflow breaks down. Clear documentation makes that learning useful beyond the conversation. Thoughtful requirements give engineering enough context and precision to build the right thing. Demos and troubleshooting close the loop by showing whether the product works in practice.

At Kinesso, I built a repeatable research practice across a suite of more than 20 products. I conducted customer interviews, worked from transcripts, tested prototypes, documented findings in Figma, and shared what we learned with product teams and stakeholders. I also helped scale product design from 2 to 30 people while supporting enterprise analytics used by more than 7,000 people across 22 brands.

In my current work at Hedgehox and One Block Away, I turn unclear client questions into structured requirements, working AI POCs, demo flows, and build-ready handoffs. I work across product strategy, UX, AI workflow design, front-end and backend logic, and client iteration. Earlier in my career, seven years of Fortune 500 healthcare account leadership taught me how to ask precise questions, communicate clearly, and keep complex work moving across clients and internal teams.

Planning Pod is building an AI-native platform with a small team while staying accountable to 1,200 existing customers. That makes customer learning, clear decisions, and steady follow-through especially important. I am based in Raleigh, and working in person with the CTO and engineering team fits the hands-on nature of the role.

I would bring experience without needing distance from the work. I would be glad to do the interviews, write the documentation, chase down details, answer questions, and help the team build a product that reflects how customers actually work.

Wally Mostafa